

How we Test

The DMTRC: An information centre

When it comes to insights into digital products and technology, you should be able to bank upon the best. That's where the Digital Media Test & Research Centre (DMTRC) comes in. The DMTRC is the central testing resource for Digit, the place where we evaluate the latest in hardware, software and technology, as seen in the following sections. These tests and reviews are in accordance with the most cutting-edge evaluation processes and methodologies used around the world. All this is done to help you make a more calculated and informed choice on which product or technology to adopt.

Demystifying the ratings

The DMTRC brings you hardware and software product reviews in the Test Drive section of the magazine—as standalone product reviews as well as comparison tests. We test an assortment of hardware and software products from the Indian

market, and the evaluation processes involve parameters such as sheer performance, build quality, value for money and the features of the product. A set of weightages are applied to these evaluation parameters to arrive at an overall score. The table given below is used in applying the overall grades to these products based upon the overall scores.

In the case of the comparison tests, the weightages are applied to the various test parameters according to their importance. This is explained in the magazine articles and in the Test Process section of the CD, where the benchmarking methodology is explained in detail.

About our Awards

Digit rewards exceptional performance in each comparison test by picking a Best Performance winner. This award goes to the product that outshines the competition in our performance benchmarks. The Best Value award, on the other hand, is awarded to the product that we feel has the best combination of price and performance. Consider this your yardstick if you are looking for more value for your money.

VERDICTS				
A+ 20-19.5	A 19-17.5	A- 17-15.5	B+ 15-13.5	B 13-11.5
B- 11-9.5	C+ 9-7.5	C 7-5.5	C- <5	

RATINGS	
★★★★★	Excellent: a brilliant combination of price, performance and features, far beyond expectations
★★★★	Good: a good buy, better than most products in its category
★★★	Average: reasonably competent but nothing spectacular about the product
★★	Mediocre: does not live up to expectations, needs improvement in many areas
★	Poor: contains serious drawbacks and needs improvement before it can be used for the target application

In Test this Month

This month, we put 18 of the newest CD-Writers in the market through their paces – with interfaces ranging from USB to SCSI to FireWire to even the new USB 2.0 standard. The drives were tested using real-world situations such as CD copying, assorted file copying and burning over a variety of CD formats. Three benchmarking software, six cartons of test CDs written and over 54 hours of continuous burning! This month also sees the test of six of the coolest new e-mail clients with newer features and applications that are guaranteed to make your e-mailing life simpler and more fun.



What's new?

This month sees a slew of interesting products like the Logitech Cordless Freedom keyboard and mouse combination. This cool-looking input device combination gives you the best in wireless technology with a host of programmable shortcut keys for you to save time as you go about your daily work. Another mammoth piece of hardware (in specification at least) is the Maxtor D540X 160GB hard disk drive. Now it'll take you much longer to fill this drive with movies!

There's More on the CD



Due to space limitations, we carry full reviews of only the top few products in the magazine. You can find reviews of more products in the Test Drive section of our Mindware CD. This is accompanied by the detailed test and evaluation procedures used in the processor comparison test.